



Picking the perfect TV

All about screen size, panel, and smart features

For most Indian households, serious entertainment begins when they turn on their TVs – despite what the proponents of smartphones will have you believe.

From live news and broadcast, soaps and reality shows, real-time sports coverage or movies galore, the TV continues to be the centre of home entertainment in India – for full family entertainment sessions.

And there was never a better time to buy a TV in India than now. Where myriad brands are fighting for your precious eyeballs, across various price segments, each showcasing a bevy of common and unique set of features. In such a scenario, buying a TV can't just be a kneejerk reaction.

Screen size and viewing distance

Choosing the correct screen size is the foundation of an optimal viewing experience. The ideal viewing distance for a 4K UHD

television is approximately 1.6 times the diagonal screen size, ensuring your eyes perceive the full detail without spotting individual pixels. For 1080p Full HD sets, a viewing distance of 1.5 to 2.5 times the diagonal size strikes the right balance between immersion and clarity. This recommendation aligns with the SMPTE 30 standard, which targets a 30° field of view for cinematic engagement. A broader rule of thumb – dividing viewing distance (in inches) by 1.6 – offers a quick calculator for 4K TVs.

1. **Measure your seating distance:** Use a tape measure to record the distance from your primary seating position to the wall or stand where the TV will sit.
2. **Convert to inches:** Multiply meters by 39.37 to convert to inches, if needed.
3. **Apply the formula:** Divide this distance by 1.6 for 4K or use a range of 1.5–2.5 for HD.